By SHENAZ TREASURY
Actor and presenter; also one of India's leading travel content creators



Rest and Reboot

India is brimming with hotspots of healing and relaxation, offering a range of traditional therapies, and some you've never tried



INDIA PICTURE

Uttarakhand

Dubbed the world's yoga capital, Rishikesh's cup runs over with yoga and nutritional healing, with retreats available at every corner. Rishikesh hosts the renowned International Yoga Festival, too, but if you aren't one for the mad rush of a yoga festival, wellness resorts such as Vana Retreat in Dehradun and Ananda in the Himalayas near Rishikesh offer not only Ayurvedic massages and yoga, but also sowa-rigpa healing and extensive spa-and-massage programmes in a calming forest setting.

Kerala

The country's pre-eminent wellness destination is renowned for its exhaustive range of traditional massages and Ayurvedic therapies, including panchakarma treatment, abhyanga massage and healing techniques like shirodhara. From luxurious resorts located in scenic natural landscapes to modest retreats offering healing programmes with a view of the ocean or the backwaters to boot, Kerala is the place to be for all-round wellness. In Kovalam, Somatheeram Ayurveda Village (supposed to be the world's first Ayurveda beach resort) is a complete yoga and healing centre.



INDIA PICTURE

Tamil Nadu

Sound healing has quietly made waves in the past few years, and there's nowhere better to experience this than Auroville, where Svaram Sound Experience conducts hour-long sound baths or healing sessions. Or head to Arka Wellness Centre (with a guest house) within the township, where a range of holistic healing techniques can be undertaken, from yogic healing massages and reiki to therapeutic interventions from all over the world.



Ladakh

Ladakh promises a slow life where you immerse yourself headlong into nature, benefitting from the nutritious organic produce (it abounds in seasonal fruits, including apricots, apples, peaches and mulberries). Of late, yoga and wellness retreats where participants are taught breathwork and meditation have also come up. Many eco-resorts offer Tibetan healing sessions and travellers can sign up for amchi sessions (consultations with local practitioners of Tibetan medicine).



INDIA PICTURE